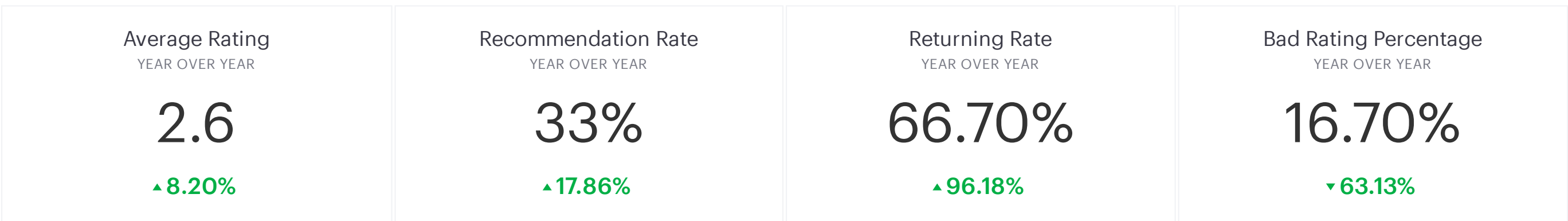


Customer Experience Intelligence — Delta Air Lines

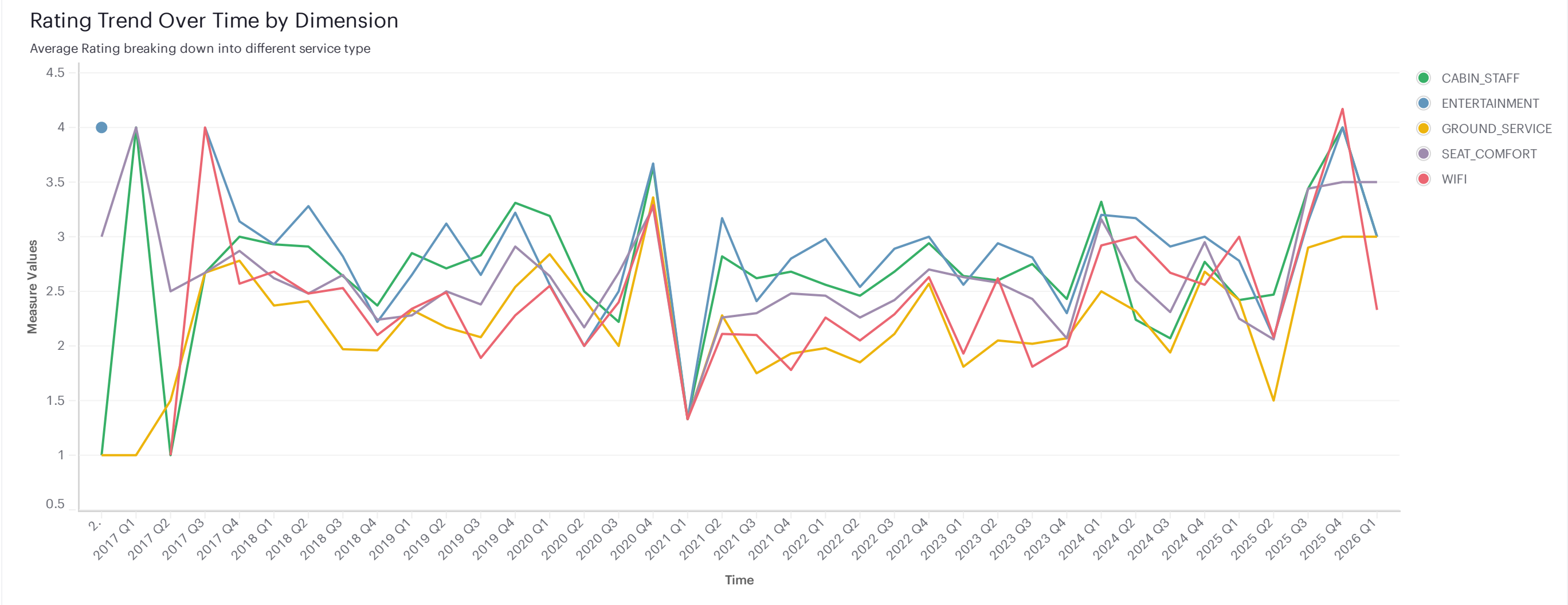
Last updated: April 12nd, 2026
Author: Gina Nguyen
Source: AirlineQuality.com · Verified Reviews · 2017-Q1 2026

At a Glance — How Are We Doing?



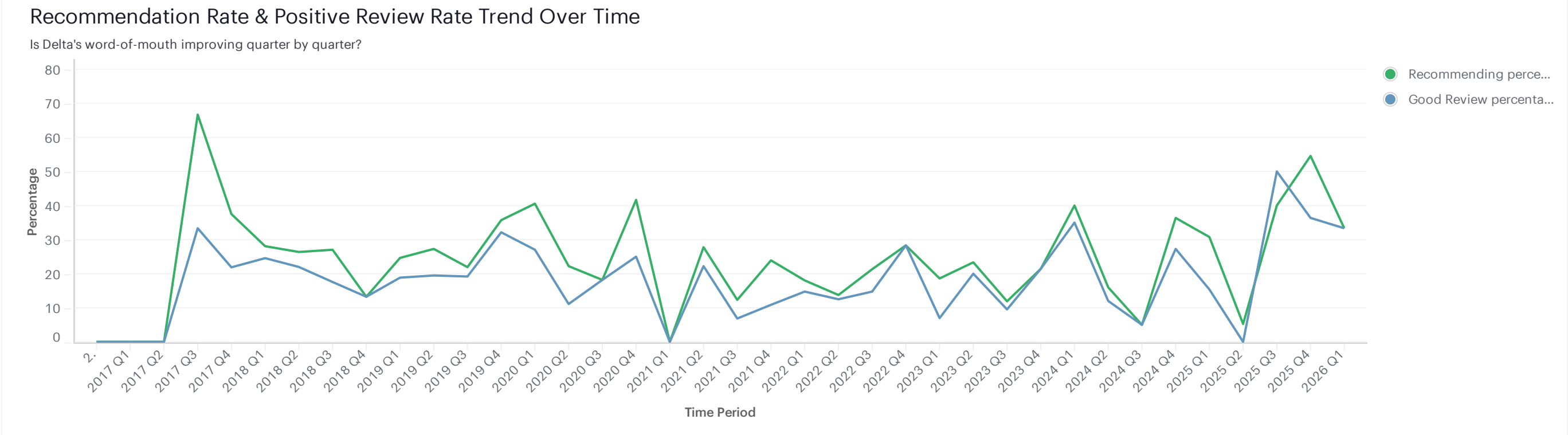
Takeaway: All four KPIs moved in the right direction. Improving but from a low base. The loyalty trap — retained but not delighted — is the core tension to resolve.

Recommendation: Set Recommendation Rate > 40% as the 12-month north star metric. It is the single most correlated indicator of organic growth.



Takeaway: Cabin Staff — consistently the highest dimension across all 9 years. WiFi — consistently the lowest. Ground Service — most volatile, frequently hits the floor. 2020–2021 — COVID distortion, exclude from baselines. 2025 upswing — visible across all dimensions, aligns with KPI improvements.

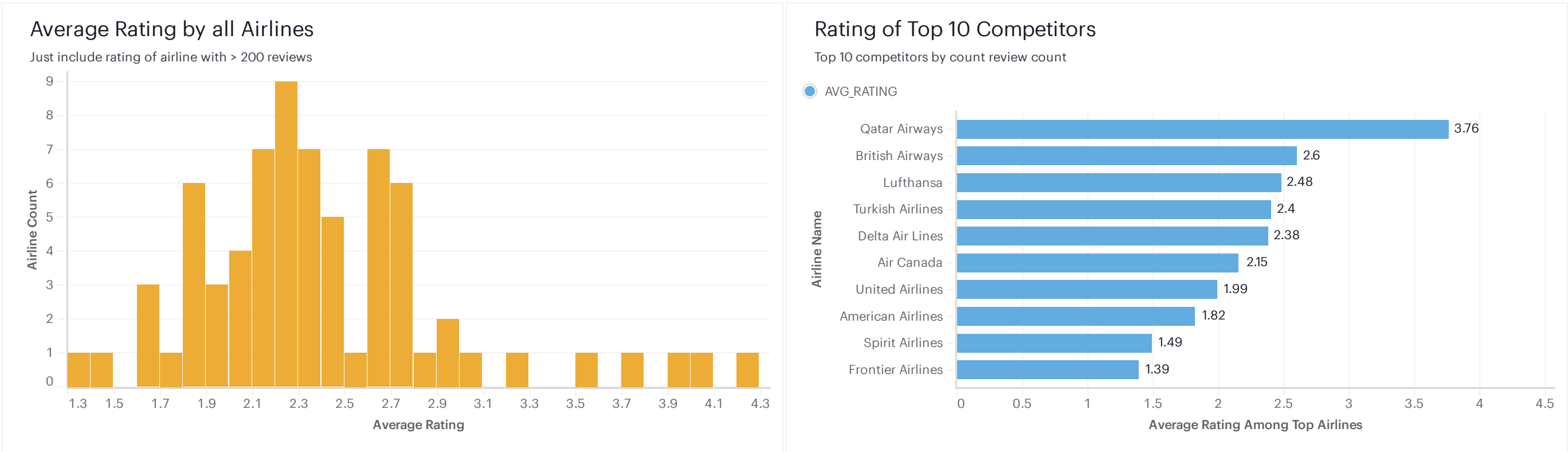
Recommendation: WiFi requires capital investment, not process fixes. 9 years of data is the business case. Protect Cabin Staff quality — it is the only thing consistently working.



Takeaway: Both lines track closely together — passengers who rate positively also recommend, confirming they measure the same underlying sentiment. The 2025 Q3 spike to ~55% is the strongest reading in the entire dataset but dropped sharply in Q1 2026, suggesting it may be seasonal rather than a sustained shift.

Recommendation: Don't celebrate the 2025 spike yet — monitor Q2–Q3 2026 to confirm whether the upward trend holds before reporting it as a structural improvement.

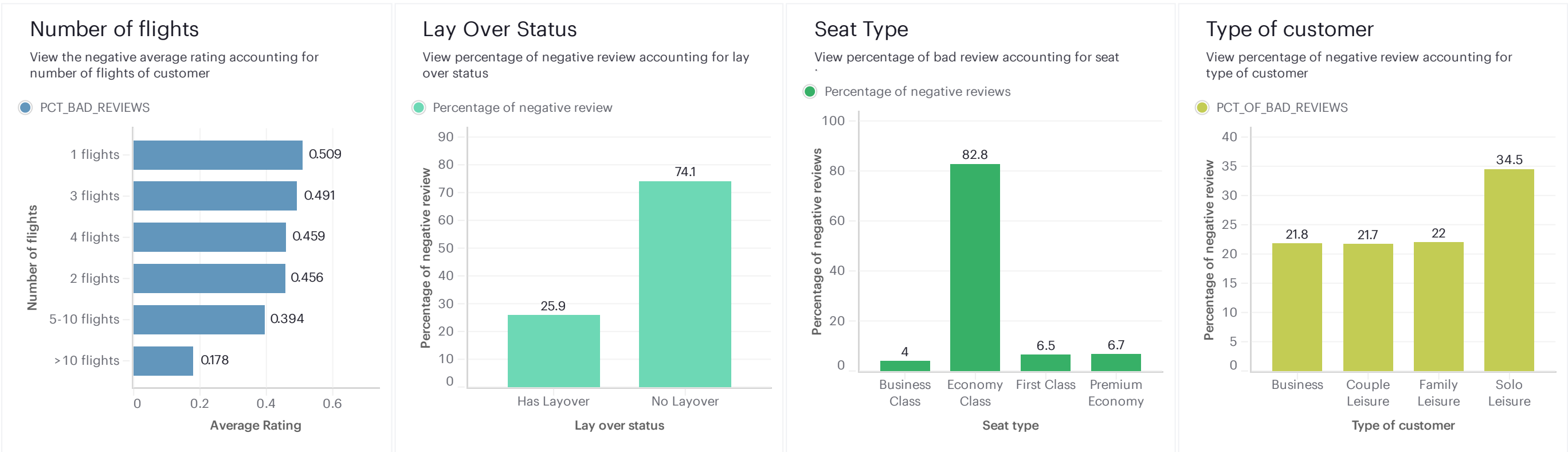
How Do We Stack Up Against Competitors?



Takeaway: Delta leads all US domestic carriers. Delta ranks #5 of 10 among most-reviewed airlines globally while Qatar Airways leads at 3.76. Nearest rivals: Turkish Airlines (2.40), Lufthansa (2.48) — less than 0.10 pts gap.

Recommendation: The realistic 12-month target is Lufthansa (2.48), not Qatar. Monitor United (1.99) closely — a 0.39-point gap is not a safe buffer.

What's Driving Negative Experiences?



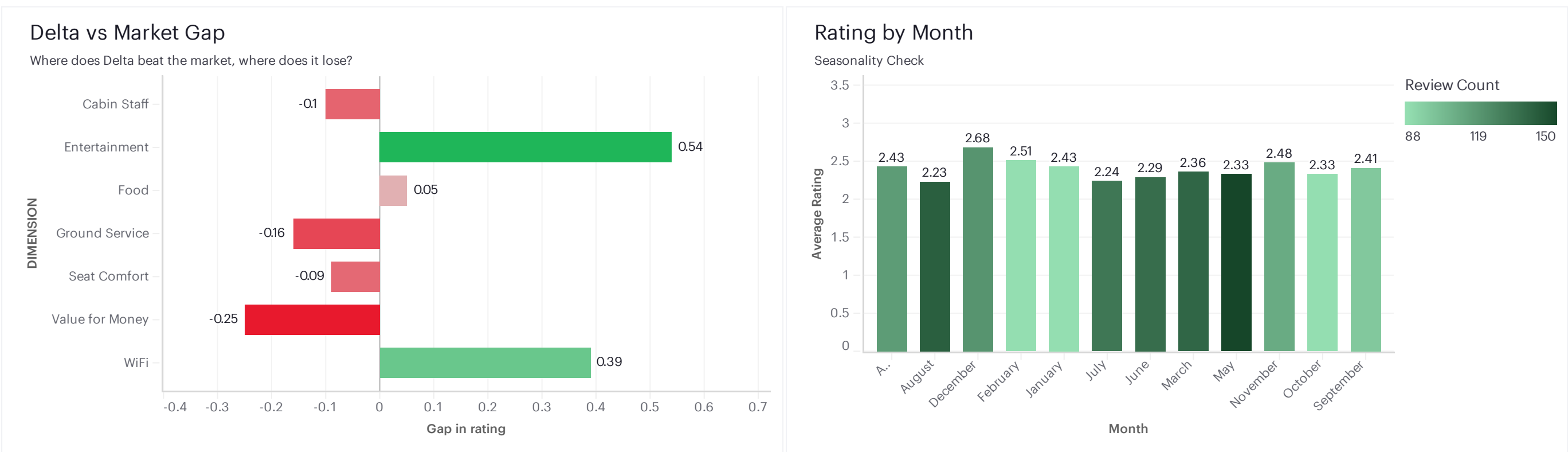
Flyer Frequency — Bad review rate drops from 0.509 (1 flight) to 0.178 (10+ flights). First-time passengers are 3x more likely to leave a bad review. First impressions are failing. Loyal customers are more forgiving

Layover Status — 74.1% of bad reviews come from one-time passengers. The in-flight experience is the problem, not connections or hubs.

Seat Type — Economy accounts for 82.8% of bad reviews. Business Class only 4%. Premium product is working. Economy is where the crisis lives.

Traveller Type — Solo Leisure leads at 34.5%, others cluster at 21–22%. Solo Leisure passengers have the highest WiFi and entertainment expectations — Delta's two weakest dimensions.

Other insights ?



Takeaway: Delta beats the market on Entertainment (+0.54) and WiFi (+0.39). This means competitors are even worse on those dimensions, not that Delta is good. Value for Money (-0.25) and Ground Service (-0.16) are Delta's below-market weaknesses.

Recommendation: Set Recommendation Rate > 40% as the 12-month north star metric.

Takeaway: February and May (2.48) are the strongest months. July (2.24) and June (2.29) are the weakest — peak summer travel correlates directly with lower satisfaction, likely driven by overcrowding, delays, and stressed staff.

Recommendation: Pre-emptively increase service resources in June–July.

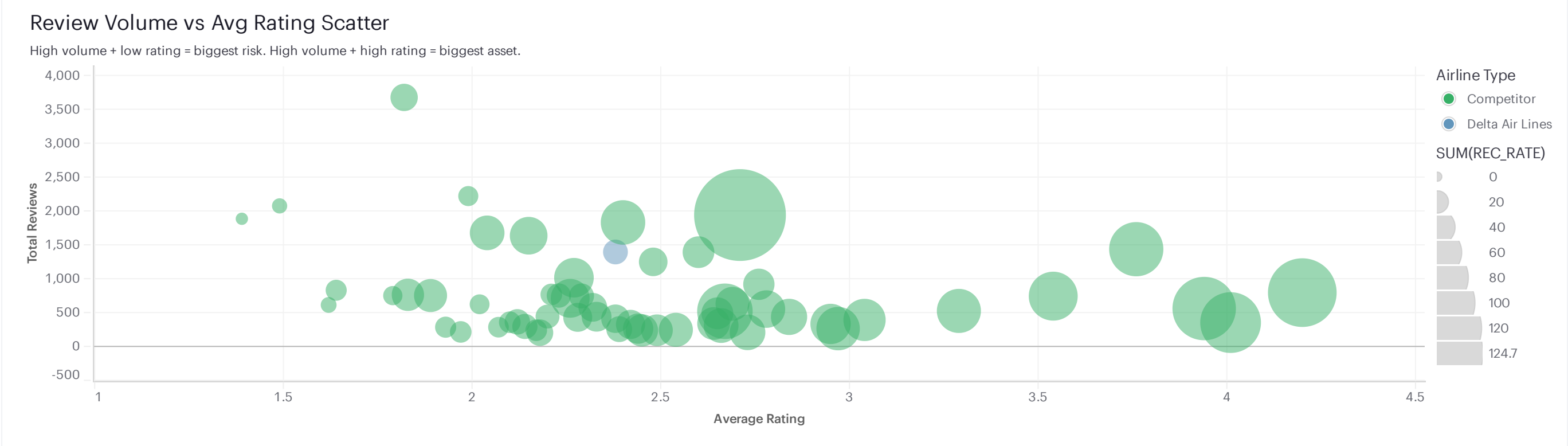


Takeaway: Boeing 767 leads on overall rating (3.5) and WiFi (3.24). Boeing 757 has the lowest seat comfort (2.5) and lowest WiFi (2.81) despite being a common domestic workhorse. A330 scores highest on WiFi (4.0)

Recommendation: Prioritise WiFi upgrades on the 757 fleet first — it's the weakest performer on the most passenger-sensitive dimension and likely handles high-volume domestic routes.

Takeaway: Boeing significantly outperforms Airbus across all three metrics. The gap is consistent, not driven by a single outlier model.

Recommendation: When making fleet procurement decisions, passenger experience data supports Boeing — this is a concrete, data-backed argument for future aircraft investment conversations.



Takeaway: Delta (blue dot) sits in the middle cluster — moderate volume, average rating around 2.4. The danger zone (top-left: high volume + low rating) contains several large green bubbles that are direct competitors. Delta is not in crisis territory but has no buffer either.

Recommendation: Moving rightward on the x-axis (improving rating) before volume grows further. High visibility with mediocre ratings is a reputational risk .